

OCCUPATIONS CODE

TITLE 13. SPORTS, AMUSEMENTS, AND ENTERTAINMENT

SUBTITLE A-1. TEXAS RACING ACT

CHAPTER 2021. GENERAL PROVISIONS

Sec. 2021.001. SHORT TITLE. This subtitle may be cited as the Texas Racing Act.

Added by Acts 2017, 85th Leg., R.S., Ch. 963 (S.B. [1969](#)), Sec. 1.01, eff. April 1, 2019.

Sec. 2021.002. PURPOSE. The purpose of this subtitle is to provide for the strict regulation of horse racing and greyhound racing and the control of pari-mutuel wagering in connection with that racing.

Added by Acts 2017, 85th Leg., R.S., Ch. 963 (S.B. [1969](#)), Sec. 1.01, eff. April 1, 2019.

Sec. 2021.003. GENERAL DEFINITIONS. In this subtitle:

(1) "Accredited Texas-bred horse" means a Texas-bred horse that meets the accreditation requirements of the state horse breed registry for that breed of horse.

(2) "Active license" means a racetrack license designated by the commission as active.

(3) "Appaloosa horse" means a horse that is registered by the Appaloosa Horse Club.

(4) "Applicant" means a person with a legal, equitable, or beneficial interest in a license application.

(5) "Arabian horse" means a horse that is registered by the Arabian Horse Association or by the Canadian Arabian Horse Registry.

(6) "Breakage" means the odd cents by which the amount payable on each dollar wagered exceeds a multiple of 10 cents, except in a minus pool, in which the breakage must be in multiples of five cents.

(7) "Child" means an individual younger than 16 years of age.

(8) "Commission" means the Texas Racing Commission.

(9) "Concessionaire" means a person licensed by the commission to sell refreshments or souvenirs at a racetrack.

(10) "Contraband" means:

(A) an item the possession of which is unlawful under this subtitle, a commission rule, or other law;

(B) an item that might reasonably have the effect of unnaturally depressing, stimulating, or exciting an animal during a race in a manner contrary to this subtitle or a commission rule, including a prohibited device or prohibited substance; or

(C) a document, including a credential or forged ticket, possessed or used by an individual in violation of this subtitle or a commission rule.

(11) "Credential" means any document indicating authority or permission under this subtitle, including a license, certificate, and identification card.

(12) "Cross-species simulcast signal" means a simulcast signal of a horse race at a greyhound racetrack or a simulcast signal of a greyhound race at a horse racetrack.

(13) "Enclosure" means all areas of a racetrack association's grounds, including the parking area, to which admission is ordinarily obtained only on payment of an admission fee or presentation of an official credential.

(14) "Executive director" means the executive director of the commission.

(15) "Greyhound" means a purebred greyhound dog registered by the National Greyhound Association.

(16) "Greyhound racing" means any race in which two or more greyhounds engage in a contest of speed or endurance or pursue a mechanical lure.

(17) "Greyhound racing day" means a day on which a racetrack association conducts greyhound racing. "One racing day" means a period beginning at noon and ending at 2 a.m. the next calendar day, other than a day on which a matinee performance is conducted.

(18) "Horse race meeting" means the conducting of horse races on a day or during a period of consecutive or nonconsecutive days.

(19) "Horse racing day" means the 24-hour period ending at 12 midnight.

(20) "Horsemen's organization" means an organization recognized by the commission that:

(A) represents horse owners and trainers in negotiating and contracting with racetrack associations on subjects relating to racing; and

(B) represents and advocates the interests of horse owners and trainers before administrative, legislative, and judicial forums.

(21) "Inactive license" means a racetrack license designated by the commission as inactive.

(22) "Judge" means a racing official with general authority and supervision over:

(A) the conduct of a greyhound race meeting; and